

Large wasp nest removed

MANGALURU, DHNS: A large wasp nest spotted on a road-side tree in front of the KS-RTC depot at Mukrampady in Puttur was removed on Friday night following complaints from the residents.

The nest had been noticed on a tree along the roadside a few days ago. During the daytime, wasps were reportedly causing inconvenience to pedestrians and others using the road. Residents became concerned after noticing monkeys disturbing the nest, fearing that any damage to it could trigger an attack.

Taking the complaint seriously, Puttur MLA Ashok Rai directed party workers to take immediate steps to remove the nest. The matter was also brought to the notice of the Forest Department.

Following the MLA's instructions, the nest was destroyed on Friday evening using a crane and fire as part of the removal operation. More than 50 party workers and the locals took part in the operation.

"On Thursday, the residents informed me about the wasp nest. With the intention of preventing a repeat of the Padnur incident, I instructed that the nest be removed. Accordingly, it was removed," Ashok Rai said.

Jumbo menace: Govt yet to release Rs 73 lakh crop loss relief for DK

Sullia MLA seeks permanent measures to address issue

Raising concerns over the increasing elephant menace in Dakshina Kannada, Sullia MLA Bhagirathi Murulya urged the Forest Department and the district administration to take permanent measures to prevent elephants from straying into agricultural fields and plantations.

Farmers in the district are already facing distress due to the yellow leaf and leaf spot diseases affecting arecanut plantations. The frequent stray of elephants into farmlands has further aggravated their problems, she said.

The MLA was speaking at the District Development Co-ordination and Monitoring Committee (DISHA) meeting chaired by Dakshina Kannada MP Capt Brijesh Chowta on Saturday. Murulya said the Forest Department should install solar fencing along the periphery of forest areas to prevent elephants from entering agricultural land.

Officials informed the meeting that a proposal to establish an elephant camp at Gundya had been submitted to the government, but the approval was yet to be received. An Elephant Task Force comprising 25 personnel is currently operational in Dakshina Kannada, and efforts are being made to drive the elephants back into the forest.

During 2026-27, Rs 3.30 lakh has been released as compensation to 19 people for crop losses caused by elephants. However, compensation amounting to Rs 73 lakh is yet to be released to 381 people whose crops have been damaged. The officials said the compensation would be disbursed to the affected farmers once the government releases the funds.

Officials said around 80 elephants were involved in damaging crops in Sullia, Belthangady areas. Farmers are being provided a 50% subsidy for



MP Capt Brijesh Chowta speaks at a Disha meeting at the Zilla Panchayat Hall in Mangaluru on Saturday. DH PHOTO

installing solar fencing as a measure to prevent elephant incursions, officials said.

DC Darshan H V said he would discuss the issue with the DCF and CCF and explore permanent measures to address the elephant menace.

Bajpe Town Panchayat President Lokesh Poojary accused the Forest Department of failing to take action against GMPL after a peacock was found dead within its premises and allegedly buried by the company personnel without informing the department.

Forest officials said they had visited the spot after receiving information about the incident. However, the company staff had already buried the peacock. The carcass was later

exhumed and a post-mortem examination was conducted. However, officials said nothing conclusive could be established as the carcass was in a decomposed condition.

Taking note of the issue, the DC questioned the officials about why an FIR had not been registered against the company for allegedly violating the rules. He directed the officials to initiate steps to file an FIR immediately.

Feasibility study

MP Capt Brijesh Chowta directed the railway officials to conduct a feasibility study for establishing a railway station near the Mangaluru International Airport.

He suggested that the existing Jokatte railway station could either be upgraded or a suitable location near the airport could be identified for a new station. He also stressed the need for establishing a new Mangaluru North railway station. The railway officials informed the meeting that a tender had been floated for establishing a stabling line in the Goods Shed area at Bunder.

Rs 23 crore proposal

Moodbidri MLA Umanath Kotian alleged that water from the Mangaluru airport area enters residential houses during heavy rainfall, causing inconvenience to residents.

PWD officials said a proposal for Rs 23 crore had been prepared to upgrade the rajakaluve (major stormwater drain) from the airport runway to the PWD road under the jurisdiction of Kandavara Gram Panchayat. Officials said an estimate would also have to be prepared for the rajakaluve falling within the limits of the Bajpe Town Panchayat.

The MLA said a meeting involving the MP, MLA, airport authorities and officials concerned should be convened by the DC after the estimates are prepared to discuss measures to address waterlogging.

Works at plastic park expected to be completed by end of Sept: Officials

MANGALURU, DHNS: The ongoing works at the Plastic Park are expected to be completed by the end of September, officials told the Disha meeting chaired by MP Capt Brijesh Chowta.

Officials said road works at the Plastic Park are currently in progress and the asphaltting work is expected to be completed by September-end. Street lighting and drainage works have already been completed, while work on the treatment plant has also been completed.

The flooring, painting and installation of windows at the administrative building of the Central Institute of Petrochemicals Engineering and Technology (CIPET) are yet to be completed.

The MP said he, along with the DC, will inspect in the first week of October and if everything is completed then the Plastic Park will be inaugurated by October end.

DC Joint Director Gokuldas Nayak said 48 developed sites were ready for allotment at the Plastic Park. A state-level screening committee headed by the Principal Secretary is expected to convene a meeting in September to consider the allotment of the sites. So far, 16 applications have been received for the sites.

ZP CEO Narwade Vinayak Karbhari said 968 works had been taken up under the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme during the year.

Under the Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-G RAM G) scheme, 18,000 works are planned to be taken up during the year. Of these, around 9,000 works will be related to the horticulture sector.

The target is to generate 15 lakh person-days of employment under the scheme. He said progress had been affected due to technical issues. The works would be taken up once the technical issues are resolved, they said.

The MP directed the officials to prepare an action plan to ensure that houses are constructed for eligible Koraga families under the scheme.

ITDP officer Basavaraju said there are 1,135 Koraga families in DK and all of them have been mapped under PM-JANMAN. The applications of 165 beneficiaries under various schemes, including PM-JANMAN, have been processed, while 124 applications are awaiting approval.

He said there were no financial constraints for implementing the housing programme. However, some beneficiaries who had already received approval for house construction had not come forward to commence the work.

DISHA Committee member Bharath Kumar pointed out that the cost of construction materials had increased considerably and said the sanctioned amount of Rs 4.5 lakh was inadequate to construct a house.

BC Road-Surathkal bypass planned

A bypass road connecting BC Road and Surathkal is being planned, Chowta said. The DPR for the proposed alignment is in the final stage.

MLA Rajesh Naik pointed out that the road stretch between Polali Dhvara and Narayana Guru Circle at BC Road was narrow and required attention. Deputy Commissioner said NHAI land would be identified along the Surathkal-BC Road stretch.

The DC said 68% of the waterfront project being implemented by the Mangaluru Smart City Limited had been completed. The project had been delayed as port land had been leased for 30 years. The encroachments on the land now need to be cleared, he said. Around 80% of the work on the road connecting Sultan Bathery and Tannirbavi has also been completed. The road is expected to be ready by December, officials said.

Young athletes told to draw inspiration from hockey legend Dhyhan Chand

MANGALURU, DHNS

Hockey legend Major Dhyhan Chand created a glorious chapter in the Indian sports history through his outstanding achievements and brought international recognition to the country, said M A Gafoor, the Chairman of Coastal Development Board.

Speaking after inaugurating the National Sports Day celebrations and Dakshina Kannada district-level swimming competition at the Emmekere International Swimming Pool on Saturday, Gafoor said the younger generation should

strive to recreate the history made by Dhyhan Chand through talent, dedication and hard work. The event was organised jointly by the district administration, Dakshina Kannada Zilla Panchayat, Mangaluru City Corporation, Department of Youth Empowerment and Sports, and V One Aqua Centre to mark the birth anniversary of Major Dhyhan Chand.

In Udupi

MLA Udupi Suvarna urged young athletes from the district to draw inspiration from hockey legend Major Dhyhan Chand and strive to win Olympic medals

and achieve recognition at the international level. He was speaking after inaugurating a mega blood donation camp organised as part of the National Sports Day celebrations.

He paid floral tributes to the portrait of Major Dhyhan Chand.

Suvarna said the union government had accorded greater importance to sports over the past decade. "Through the Khelo India programme, talented sportspersons from different parts of the country were being identified, provided scholarships and encouraged to pursue sports."

'Multilingualism can strengthen bonds among communities'

MANGALURU, DHNS: The Manipuri Language Day was celebrated at the Alva's College at Moodbidri on Saturday to highlight the importance of preserving the language, culture and identity associated with it.

Speaking at the programme, Dr Linthoingambi Chanu, the Head of Department of Neurology, Alva's College of Physiotherapy, said language was not merely a means of communication but reflected the history, experiences, emotions, culture and identity of a community. "No language

is superior to another. Every language has its own significance and distinctiveness," she said.

She urged students to learn different languages to understand the cultures and lived experiences of diverse communities.

Multilingualism, she said, could promote mutual understanding and strengthen bonds among communities. She also stressed the need to respect

people irrespective of their language, culture, religion or place of origin and to give priority to cooperation and harmony over hatred and conflict.

Alva's College Principal Dr Kurian was present.

A book titled Bedtime Stories, translated from English into Manipuri by Chungkam Priyadevi, the Head of Department of Manipuri, was also released on the occasion.



Celebrity chef and TV host Oggarane Dabbi Murali with the top three winners of the cooking competition, 'Cuisines of Karnataka'--organised by Prajavani and Deccan Herald, in association with LG Ingu and Freedom Cooking Oil, at the Lions Seva Mandir in Mangaluru on Saturday. DH PHOTOS/FAKRUDDIN H



Murali tastes dishes prepared by the contestants.

Feast of authentic coastal, North K'taka delicacies unfolds at 'Cuisines of Karnataka'

MANGALURU, DHNS

The Lions Seva Mandir Hall in Mallikarte was filled with all kinds of aromas as contestants across ages opened their bags, on receiving the cue from organisers, to place their perfectly home-cooked dishes across the table on Saturday.

Soon, Manji tawa fry, mackerel fry, mackerel gassi, bolanjir rava fry, crab gassi, bondas fry, prawn rolls, pepper chicken, Odapale kori sukka, kori pulimunchi, dum biryani, chicken fry, Tyson sukka, amaranth-leaf fritters, banana stem palya, minced gatti, semige, patrode, neer dosa and nuchinunde—an impressive variety of authentic coastal delicacies were on display to be judged by celebrity chef and popular TV hosts Oggarane Dabbi Murali at the cooking competition 'Cuisines of Karnataka', organised by *Prajavani* and *Deccan Herald* in association with LG Ingu and Freedom Cooking Oil.

Competing for attention



were mouth-watering north Karnataka specialties like jowar rotti, sajje rotti and khadak rotti, and ragi mudde with chicken sukka. Sweet dishes, including turmeric-leaf kadubu, kuchalakki laddu, mango laddu and poppy-seed dry-fruit laddu, along with a variety of juices, tantalised the taste buds of food lovers. A festive atmosphere prevailed at the hall. Each contestant waited nervously as Murali stopped at their table to taste their dishes.

Mala Bhat had prepared nuchinunde using lentils, dill leaves, curry leaves and coriander. Durga, a final-year engi-

PRIZE WINNERS

- First Prize: Priya Naik, Udupi
- Second Prize: Praveena Harish
- Third Prize: Sandhya, Udupi, and Dhanalakshmi Jnanasekhar, Panambur
- Consolation Prizes: Kalpana Rao, Huligemma, Durga, Ranjitha Dongre, Annapoornima, Mala Bhat and Pragnya G Pai

neering student, had prepared creamy chicken and lemon coriander rice. Ramya Shetty, a Mangaluru resident, originally from Yellapur, had prepared chicken sukka. Students Nagashree, Annapoornima, Suchithra, Aishwarya, Sharada (first year BA), Likitha, Nagashree and Akkamahadevi (final year BA) of Government First Grade College in Kavorr had prepared mouth watering dishes of North Karnataka.

Their spread included beet-root palya, green gram palya, chickpea palya, different varieties of ladoos, pickles and payasa. Fatima Rifa and her

friend from the Department of Hospitality Science at the Yenepoya Institute of Arts, Science, Commerce and Management were appreciated for their neer dosa and chicken sukka.

Cash prizes of Rs 18,000, Rs 15,000 and Rs 10,000 were awarded to the first, second and third prize winners, respectively. Seven contestants received consolation prizes of Rs 1,000 each. All the participants, from ages 17 to 70, received certificates of appreciation. Chandra Nayak, who tagged the event on the Instagram page, was also given a prize.

Lions Club President Shobhita, Regional Chairman Asha Nagaraj, Freedom Cooking Oil's local distributor Vasudev Shenoy, Santosh Kumar, Ravindra from LG Ingu, Shruthi from KMF, Uday Kumar, Narasimha Murthy, Ganesh Chandanshiv from the *Prajavani-Deccan Herald* group, and Pramod from the brand division were present at the prize distribution ceremony.

Japan's Festival of Colours is About to Begin...

This is the perfect time to visit!

Soon, Japan's mountains, gardens, temples and streets will be dressed in spectacular shades of red, gold, orange and crimson. This is Japan in autumn. A sight to capture in your eyes and cherish in your heart!

You don't want to miss out!

Chalo, Bag Bharo, Nikal Pado!

This autumn, travel to Japan with Veena World!

Book Online

Gift a Tour This Festive Season!

Veena World Gift Cards

Pick your favourite Veena World Far East Asia tour this Autumn!

Best of Japan+Nagoya (7D) Oct 1, 8, 23, 29, Nov 5, Dec 6 183K-198K (J&L) 253K-268K (Ex-BLR)	All of Japan 8 Days - Nov 17 220K-230K (J&L) 305K-315K (Ex-BLR)	Wonders of Japan (9D) Sep 26, Oct 19, Nov 9, 27 250K-260K (J&L) 325K-335K (Ex-BLR)	Marvels of Japan 11 Days - Oct 25, Nov 15 309K-319K (J&L) 389K-399K (Ex-BLR)
Japan Korea 10 Days - Nov 4, 13 300K-310K (J&L) 365K-375K (Ex-BLR)	Korea Taiwan 8 Days - Oct 21 240K-250K (J&L) 310K-320K (Ex-BLR)	Women's Special Japan 7 Days - Nov 15 191K-201K (J&L) 261K-271K (Ex-BLR)	Seniors' Special Japan 7 Days - Nov 29 198K-208K (J&L) 268K-278K (Ex-BLR)

Group tour price includes return airfare (Ex-Bengaluru), transport, accommodation, all meals: breakfast, lunch, dinner, sightseeing with entrance fees, driver-guide tips, services of a Tour Manager, VISA fee and travel insurance*. J&L tours exclude airfare, visa & insurance. The full payment benefit is valid only for a limited period!

Veena World Sales Office
Karnataka
Jayanagar 887 997 2217
Indiranagar 887 997 9500

veenaworld.com
Call: 1800 313 5555
Mon-Sat 10 to 7
travel@veenaworld.com

Now book flights on Veena World!
Scan to book

VEENA WORLD
Travel. Explore. Celebrate Life.

Veena World Sales Partners: Karnataka: Belgaum-Goaes Circle 7338685500 • Belgaum-College Rd 9980428880 Bijapur 9980857595 • Hubli 7204411007 Malleshwaram 9845066469 • Dharwad 9036715969 • Bengaluru-Vijayanagar 9036610005 • Chikodi 9448627771 • Tamil Nadu: Coimbatore 9994665222

For Mysore, Udupi, Mangaluru • Please Call: 865 575 5281

Tour price is per person and on twin sharing basis. These tour prices are nett and no discount is applicable. At the time of booking, tour price to be paid in full INR by UPI/NEFT/RTGS/Cheque, in the name of 'Veena World Hospitality Pvt. Ltd.'. No cash transactions at Veena World. Government taxes apply. Any increase in YO taxes, airport taxes, VISA fees, surcharges (if any) will have to be borne by the travellers. T&C apply.